Sophie Mainz

Postdoctoral Researcher
GESIS Leibniz Institute for the Social Sciences - Germany
Department of Government - Uppsala University - Sweden
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Academic Positions

Postdoctoral researcher at GESIS Leibniz Institute for the Social Sciences, Germany since 10/2026

Visiting researcher at the European University Institute, Italy 2025-2026

Visiting researcher at Columbia University, New York 2025

Education

PhD in Political Science at Uppsala University, Sweden 2021-2026
Supervisors: Alexandra Segerberg, Pär Zetterberg, Carl Öhman

Graduate Schools: Doctoral training in Political Science (60 credits); Swedish Interdisciplinary Research School in Computational Social Science (SIRCSS); Wallenberg AI, Autonomous Systems and Software Program – Humanities and Society (WASP-HS) Graduate School

Pre-doc in Political Science at Graz University, Austria 2020-2021
Supervisor: Bilgin Ayata

MSc Political Science at Uppsala University, Sweden 2018-2020
GPA: VG (pass with distinction)

BA European Studies at Maastricht University, Netherlands 2013-2017

Publications

Peer-reviewed articles

Mainz, S. (2026). Inclusion to Exclude: How Femonationalism Impacts Policy Preferences *Political Science Research and Methods*, 1–24. Recipient of the 2025 APSA John Sullivan Award in Political Behavior

Grahn, M., Lawall, K., Mainz, S., Nordbrandt, M., & Turnbull-Dugarte, S. J. (2025). A game of tariffs: is there demand for tariffs in Europe? *Journal of European Public Policy*, 1–18.

Working papers

Mainz, S., Grahn, M., Lawall, K., & Turnbull-Dugarte, S. J. (under review). "Not in Her Name": Strategic Rebuttals to the Gendered Defence of Illiberal Exclusion. *Presented at APSA 2025*

Grahn, M., Lawall, K., **Mainz, S.**, Nordbrandt Bergström, M. & Turnbull-Dugarte, S. J. (under review). Can Ecological Frames Make Nativist Governments More Acceptable?

Turnbull-Dugarte, S. J., **Mainz, S.**, Lawall, K., & Grahn, M. (under review). When Liberalism Fails to Legitimize Far-Right Accommodation

Mainz, S. (working paper). Hijacking Feminism: The Normalising Work of Gender Issues on Far-Right Social Media. *To be presented at APSA 2026*

Mainz, S. (working paper). Trading Principles? How Linking Immigration to Liberal Values Shifts Public Preferences. *Presented at EPSA 2025*

Mainz, S. (working paper). Public Support for Social Media Regulation. *Presented at Conference on Democratic Political Orders and the Governance of Social Media Platforms, Stockholm University 2026*

Mainz, S. & Grahn, M. (working paper). Endorsing Retrenchment: Voter Preferences and the Rollback of Transgender Rights in the UK *To be presented at EPSS 2026*

Research Assistantships

Uppsala University, *Uppsala, Sweden* 2022-2025
Science communication on digital visual climate communication with Alexandra Segerberg

Graz University, *Graz, Austria* 2020-2021
Research on migration and digital data with Bilgin Ayata

Leibniz Institute for the Social Sciences (GESIS), *Mannheim, Germany* 2019
Research on survey methods and sampling of vulnerable migrant populations with Dorothée Behr and Steffen Pötzschke

Uppsala University, *Uppsala, Sweden* 2019
Research on resentment and populism on social media with Johanna Söderström

Teaching

Uppsala University

Bachelor Thesis Course, Department of Government	2023, 2024, 2025
The Problem of Democracy, Department of Government	2022, 2023, 2024
Methods consultation, Department of Government	2023, 2024
Computational Social Sciences, IT Department	2023, 2024
Introduction to R, Department of Government	2023
Supervisor for Bachelor Thesis, Department of Government	2023

Graz University

Postcolonial Studies	2021
Race, Racism and Racialization	2021
Migration Studies	2020

Awards

John Sullivan Award 2025
American Political Science Association, Elections, Public Opinion, and Voting Behavior Section. Recognizes the best paper by a graduate student for my paper "Inclusion to Exclude: How Femonationalism Impacts Policy Preferences."

Scholarships

Wallenberg Foundation 2021-2026
Full doctoral scholarship by the Wallenberg AI Autonomous Systems and Software Program - Humanities and Social Sciences (WASP-HS)

Karl Staaffs Fond 2023, 2024, 2025
Scholarships for data collection and research visit abroad

Anna Maria Lundins Stipendiefond 2023, 2024, 2025
Scholarships for conference attendance and travel

Borbos Hanssons Stipendiefond 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026
Scholarships for conference attendance, travel and research visit abroad

Helge Ax:sson Stiftelse 2026
Scholarship for independent research

Swedish Network for European Studies in Political Science (SNES) Stipend 2025
Scholarship for six month visiting fellowship at the European University Institute

Siamon Stiftelse 2024
Scholarship for conference attendance and travel

Stiftelsen Lars Hiertas Minne 2023
Scholarship for data collection

Women in Political Methodology (WPM) 2023
Fellowship and travel stipend

Swedish Interdisciplinary Research School in Computational Social Science (SIRCSS) 2023
Fellowship and several travel stipends

Organization of Academic Events

Conference Panel on Gender and Conservative Backlash 2025
EPSA, University Carlos III of Madrid
Organisation of conference panel with Katharina Lawall

Conference Panel on Femonationalism 2025
EPSA, University Carlos III of Madrid

Organisation of conference panel with Katharina Lawall

Seminar Series on Methods in Political Science 2023 - 2026
Founder and organiser of the PolMethods Seminar Series
Department of Government, Uppsala University, Sweden

Workshop on AI and Political Communication 2024
WASP-HS Winter Conference, Umeå University, Sweden

Workshop on Generative AI in Political Science 2023
Marholmen Conference, Uppsala University, Sweden

Workshop on R for Political Scientists 2023
Department of Government, Uppsala University, Sweden

The German-Canadian Conference on Migration and Integration 2019
Leibniz Institute for the Social Sciences (GESIS), University of Osnabrück, Germany

Fellowships

Women in Political Methodology (WPM) Group	since 2023
Swedish Interdisciplinary Research School in Computational Social Science (SIRCSS) Alumni	since 2023
Wallenberg AI Autonomous Systems and Software Program - Humanities and Social Sciences	since 2021
Digital Politics Network (DigPol), Uppsala	since 2021

Presentations

Workshops

Bridging Boundaries: Advancing Gender and Politics through Quantitative Methods, LMU	2025
Consequences of Identity Politics Workshop, Southampton University	2024

Conferences

American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting	2024, 2025
European Political Science Society (EPSS) Annual Conference	2026
European Political Science Association (EPSA) Annual Conference	2024, 2025
Democratic Political Orders and the Governance of Social Media Platforms Conference	2026
NYU Rebecca B. Morton Conference on Experimental Political Science	2025
European Conference on Politics and Gender (ECPG)	2024
Nordic Political Science Association (NoPSA) Congress	2024
European Consortium for Political Research (ECPR) General Conference	2024

Professional Service and Volunteer Work

Doctoral representative to the Board for Research Infrastructure, Uppsala	2024, 2025
Doctoral representative to the Center for Digital Humanities, Uppsala	2024, 2025

Doctoral representative to the department board, Uppsala	2024
Vice-chair of PhD association, Department of Government, Uppsala	2024
Doctoral representative at WASP-HS Program	2022, 2023, 2024

Graduate Courses

Political Psychology with Don Green, Columbia University	2025
Computational Text Analysis, SIRCSS Research School, Linköping University	2024
Grant Writing, SIRCSS Research School, Linköping University	2024
Feminist Technoscience, Linköping University	2024
Business and Politics of AI, Stockholm University	2024
Causal Inference and Experiments, Essex Summer School, University of Essex	2023
Quantitative Text Analysis, Essex Summer School, University of Essex	2023
Summer Institute in Computational Social Science, SIRCSS Research School, Linköping University	2023
Academic Teacher Training, Uppsala University	2023
Summer School for Women* in Political Methodology, Basel University	2023
Social Network Analysis, ECPR Winter School, KU Leuven	2023
Presentation Course "Getting your message across", Uppsala University	2023
Introduction to Network Science, Uppsala University	2022
Python Programming,Uppsala University	2022
Ethical, Legal, and Social Impacts of AI and Autonomous Systems, Umeå University	2022
Foundations, Achievements, Conclusions of Social Science, Uppsala University	2022
Reviewing Prior Research, Uppsala University	2022
Applied Methods in Political Science, Uppsala University	2022
What is (artificial) intelligence? An Introduction to Cognitive Science, Lund University	2022
Central Analytical Perspectives, Uppsala University	2021
Methods in Political Science, Uppsala University	2021

Skills

Software and Programming: R, Python, Git, Stata
Markup: LaTeX, R Markdown, HTML
Languages: English (fluent), German (native), Swedish (fluent), French (good proficiency), Spanish (basic)

Academic Referees

Alexandra Segerberg, Uppsala University
Main Supervisor
E-mail: alexandra.segerberg@statsvet.uu.se

Pär Zetterberg, Uppsala University
Second Supervisor
E-mail: par.zetterberg@statsvet.uu.se

Carl Öhman, Uppsala University

Third Supervisor
E-mail: carl.ohman@statsvet.uu.se